

■■■■ 12-Week High-Volume 5K & Half Marathon Foundation Plan

Runner Profile & Strategy:

- **Current 5K PR:** 28:57 (Pace: 5:47 /km) | **Current VDOT:** 29.8
- **Goal:** Peak 5K speed (VDOT 40 target) + Aerobic Base (30–42.5 km/wk) for **April Half Marathon**
- **Frequency:** 4 Running Days / Week (Tue, Thu, Sat, Sun)

■ Jack Daniels Target Pace Zones (VDOT 29.8)

Zone	Purpose	Pace (Metric)	Pace (Imperial)
Easy (E)	Base building, recovery, capillary growth	7:31 – 8:25 /km	12:06 – 13:34 /mi
Marathon (M)	Aerobic endurance & long run pacing	6:40 – 7:17 /km	10:44 – 11:44 /mi
Threshold (T)	Lactate threshold & half marathon stamina	6:26 – 6:33 /km	10:21 – 10:32 /mi
Interval (I)	VO2max expansion & stroke volume	5:49 – 6:03 /km	9:21 – 9:45 /mi
Repetition (R)	Neuromuscular speed & form economy	5:23 – 5:35 /km	8:40 – 9:00 /mi

Phase 1: Aerobic Base & Lactate Threshold (Weeks 1–4)

Wk	Tuesday (Easy + Strides)	Thursday (Quality Session)	Saturday (Recovery)	Sunday (Long Run)	Total
1	6.5 km Easy + 4x100m Strides	7 km: 1.5k WU + 3x1km @ T-Pace w/ 90s + 1.5k CD	5.5 km Easy	11 km Long Run	30.0 km
2	7 km Easy + 5x100m Strides	7.5 km: 1.5k WU + 4x800m @ I-Pace w/ 2m + 1.5k CD	6 km Easy	12 km Long Run	32.5 km
3	7.5 km Easy + 5x100m Strides	8.5 km: 1.5k WU + 4x1km @ T-Pace w/ 90s + 1.5k CD	6 km Easy	13 km Long Run	35.0 km
4	6 km Easy (Deload)	6 km: 1.5k WU + 3x800m @ I-Pace + 1.5k CD	4 km Easy	10 km Benchmark	26.0 km

Phase 2: VO2max Expansion & Half Marathon Base (Weeks 5–8)

Wk	Tuesday (Easy + Strides)	Thursday (Quality Session)	Saturday (Recovery)	Sunday (Long Run)	Total
5	8 km Easy + 5x100m Strides	8.5 km: 2k WU + 15m Tempo @ T + 4x200m R + 2k CD	7 km Easy	13 km Long Run	36.5 km
6	8.5 km Easy + 6x100m Strides	9 km: 2k WU + 5x800m @ I-Pace w/ 90s + 2k CD	7 km Easy	14 km Long Run	38.5 km
7	9 km Easy + 6x100m Strides	9.5 km: 2k WU + 3x1.5km @ T-Pace w/ 2m + 2k CD	8 km Easy	14 km Long Run	40.5 km
8	6.5 km Easy (Deload)	6 km: 1.5k WU + 4x400m R-Pace + 1.5k CD	5 km Easy	■ Mid 5K Time Trial	29.5 km

Phase 3: Peak Volume, 5K Sharpening & Transition (Weeks 9–12)

Wk	Tuesday (Easy + Strides)	Thursday (Quality Session)	Saturday (Recovery)	Sunday (Long Run)	Total
9	9 km Easy + 6x100m Strides	9.5 km: 2k WU + 6x800m @ I-Pace w/ 90s + 2k CD	7.5 km Easy	15 km Progressive Run	41.0 km
10	9 km Easy + 6x100m Strides	10 km: 2k WU + 20m Tempo @ T-Pace + 2k CD	8.5 km Easy	15 km (3k M-Pace)	42.5 km
11	7.5 km Easy + 4x100m Strides	8.5 km: 2k WU + 5x1km @ 5K Goal Pace + 1.5k CD	6 km Easy	13 km Easy Base	35.0 km
12	5 km Easy + 4x100m Strides	5 km: 1.5k WU + 3x400m Shakeout + 1.5k CD	Rest Day	■ 5K RACE DAY	23.0 km

■ ■ Key Rules for High-Volume 4-Day Training

- **Protect Easy Pace:** Keep easy runs strictly between 7:30 and 8:25 /km to avoid accumulating excessive fatigue.
- **Long Run Progression:** Run the first 70% of Sunday long runs at Easy pace (7:45–8:30/km) and finish the last 20–30% at M-Pace.
- **Half Marathon Fueling Practice:** Take hydration + 1 gel at km 8 during 13–15 km Sunday runs to train your gut for April.